

UTT Chapter 04 Assignment

Hello again!

Intramurals are getting pretty intense. We have competitions every weekend now. In fact, we had three this past week! Plus homework is starting to really take its toll on me. I'm tired and sore, both physically and mentally. I wish the weekend would hurry up and get here.

You remember Sarah, right? I told you about her a few weeks ago. She's pretty nice, but ever since I told her I was a Christian, she finds opportunities to mock my beliefs. I know she's just joking, but sometimes it seems hurtful. The other day in practice, I made a really bad shot. We had a shot to take the lead, and I majorly blew it. Embarrassed, I joked, "Sorry guys! My fault. I'm a *terrible* human being!" She laughed a little sarcastically and said, "The Bible says so, right?" I didn't really appreciate her tone, but I also didn't want her to know that some of her comments bothered me.

After the game, I apologized for missing the shot. I told her that everyone makes mistakes. She agreed, but she took issue with the Christian notion of sin. I didn't exactly see what that had to do with intramurals, but she went there regardless. Before too long, she was addressing just about every "superstition" that Christianity holds dear. I don't remember everything she said, but she went on and on about the Dark Ages, the Crusades, and even the Salem witch trials. I think the gist of her point is that religion is evil. I have never heard anyone talk about Christianity like that before. Sure, I was told that I might meet some atheists in college, but this wasn't quite what I expected.

Sarah calls herself a "Secularist." I kind of know what it means to be "secular," but I don't think I fully understand where Sarah is coming from. It just seems like she *disbelieves* everything I say. I know there's gotta be more! Maybe you could help me out! You've been learning about different worldviews in school. Have you learned anything about this stuff yet?

First off, **what is a Secularist?** I know Sarah doesn't believe in the Christian view of original sin, so **what does Secularism say about humanity?** And **what does it say is wrong with us, if anything?** And if she doesn't go to church or tithe or read the Bible, what exactly *does* she do? **What does Secularism say about how we should live?** It makes my head hurt trying to figure all this stuff out. I can't believe you are learning about this kind of thing in high school. It would be great if you could help me!

I gotta go. My friends invited me to a pool tournament in the student center. I've been practicing, but I just learned how to play last month!

Wish me luck!

-Doug